

WEEK 06 / GAMING'S IMPACT ON PEOPLE AND SOCIETY

Games, Society, Religion, War, and Ethics

Exploring the impact of video games on civic engagement and the portrayal of war and violence.

This week, we explore how video games influence civic engagement and discuss the representation of war and violence in gaming. We will analyze the social and political implications of these themes and their effects on players and communities. And we'll also discuss the ethical considerations of game design and content, including the responsibilities of developers and the impact of gaming on societal norms. Finally, we'll explore how religion and spirituality are represented in games, examining the ways in which games can reflect, challenge, or reinforce religious beliefs and practices.

28 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

TOPIC 01

Civic Engagement, War, and Violence

REQUIRED

Research Roundup: Video Games and Civic Engagement

[BLOG POST](#) | ~7 MIN

<https://www.filamentgames.com/blog/research-roundup-video-games-and-civic-engagement/>

LO 3: Students will explore the applications of video games beyond entertainment, including their use in medicine, education, and social engagement.

REQUIRED

In this case, politics is a (video) game

[ARTICLE/AUDIO](#) | ~6 MIN

<https://www.npr.org/2021/11/04/1051381706/in-this-case-politics-is-a-video-game>

In this case, politics is a (video) game game

LO 3: Students will explore the applications of video games beyond entertainment, including their use in medicine, education, and social engagement.

REQUIRED

What can video games tell us about war and conflict?

ARTICLE | ~5 MIN

<https://www.iwm.org.uk/history/what-can-video-games-tell-us-about-war-and-conflict>

LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.

REQUIRED

Video Games Debate: Should Kids and Teens Be Allowed to Play Violent Video Games?

ARGUMENT SUMMARY | ~29 MIN

<https://www.britannica.com/procon/video-games-debate>

Video Games Debate: Should Kids and Teens Be Allowed to Play Violent Video Games? (from ProCon, “a leading nonpartisan site for learning the top arguments behind debatable issues of the day”)

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REQUIRED

Call of Duty: Pentagon Ops

ARTICLE | ~25 MIN

<https://www.thenation.com/article/society/call-of-duty-pentagon-ops-2/>

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REQUIRED

Stalker 2 is a survival game made by people surviving a war. Should you play it?

AUDIO | ~9 MIN

<https://www.cbc.ca/listen/live-radio/1-14-day-6/clip/16110908-stalker-2-survival-game-made-people-surviving-war>

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EXPLORE FURTHER

When A Video Game Becomes An Addiction

TED TALK

https://www.ted.com/talks/khurram_sadiq_when_a_video_game_becomes_an_addiction?subtitle=en

EXPLORE FURTHER

Military Historian breaks down Sniper Elite 5

YOUTUBE | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GIRzeJ_6wk8&ab_channel=ImperialWarMuseums

EXPLORE FURTHER

World Reborn

WEBSITE

<https://www.worldreborn.com/>

World Reborn is an interactive story game platform where players practice becoming a hero (dealing with bullying, prejudice, etc.) within the mobile game and then unlock missions to be a hero in real life.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Gamers.Vote

WEBSITE

<https://gamers.vote/>

Gamers.Vote is a platform encouraging gamers to engage in voting and civic participation.

EXPLORE FURTHER

Are Video Games Breeding an Assassination Generation?: There's a proven correlation between video games and gun violence, yet we still allow our children free access to these games, breeding an assassination generation

ARTICLE | ~6 MIN

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/1oa9cn5/cdi_proquest_miscellaneous_1847442758

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EXPLORE FURTHER

9-Year-Old Kills Friend For Bragging About Beating Him at a Video Game

YOUTUBE | ~7 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8l1arhnfKok>

The tragic tale of a 9-year-old boy who killed his friend for bragging about beating him at a video game in 1989. Although not directly related to depictions of violence in video games, this story highlights the potential for violence and aggression in gaming culture.

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EXPLORE FURTHER

Assassination Generation: Video Games, Aggression, and the Psychology of Killing

BOOK

https://www.amazon.com/Assassination-Generation-Aggression-Psychology-Killing/dp/0316265934/ref=tmm_hrd_swatch_0?encoding=UTF8&qid=&sr=

Assassination Generation: Video Games, Aggression, and the Psychology of Killing by Lieutenant Colonel Dave Grossman, Kristine Paulsen, Katie Miserany

EXPLORE FURTHER

Game Over - Gender, Race & Violence in Video Games (2000) (HD)

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LGBJch1J1rY&ab_channel=Games%26Cigarettes

EXPLORE FURTHER

On School Shootings

YOUTUBE

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=phTTGIEUX7w>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Trauma, War, & Violence | Mental Health In Tough Times

YOUTUBE

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2P9b45rH968>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Video Games Do Affect Social Outcomes: A Meta-Analytic Review of the Effects of Violent and Prosocial Video Game Play

ARTICLE | ~52 MIN

https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/discovery/openurl?institution=01MAINE_INST&vid=01MAINE_INST:UMA&volume=40&date=2014&issn=01461672&issue=5&author=Greitemeyer&genre=article&spage=578&title=Video%20Games%20Do%20Affect%20Social%20Outcomes:%20A%20Meta-Analytic%20Review%20of%20the%20Effects%20of%20Violent%20and%20Prosocial%20Video%20Game%20Play&atitle=Video%20Games%20Do%20Affect%20Social%20Outcomes:%20A%20Meta-Analytic%20Review%20of%20the%20Effects%20of%20Violent%20and%20Prosocial%20Video%20Game%20Play&sid=ProQ:assia

EXPLORE FURTHER

War Game: The Making of S.T.A.L.K.E.R. 2 Documentary

YOUTUBE | ~90 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=28CITqwxNz0>

EXPLORE FURTHER

War and Video Games

RESEARCH PROJECT | ~48 MIN

<https://digitalcommons.uri.edu/srhonorsprog/123/>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Codex: History of Video Games #266: The Best Non-Violent Video Games with James Batchelor

PODCAST | ~70 MIN

<https://codexhistoryofvideogames.libsyn.com/episode-266-the-best-non-violent-video-games-with-james-batchelor>

EXPLORE FURTHER

The Best Non-Violent Video Games

BOOK

<https://www.casemateipm.com/9781399084925/the-best-non-violent-video-games/>

The Best Non-Violent Video Games by James Batchelor

EXPLORE FURTHER

I've been ensnared into the wild life of a drug dealer in Schedule 1

ARTICLE

<https://www.polygon.com/gaming/553156/schedule-1-impressions-weed-drug-game>

EXPLORE FURTHER

Phantasmagoria (PC) - Retro Gaming Review

YOUTUBE | ~13 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YDj-MdyDdwU&ab_channel=CannotbeTamed

EXPLORE FURTHER

A Conversation with Roberta Williams (Phantasmagoria Reunion)

YOUTUBE

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-z8Eg0ljOac&ab_channel=ConversationswithCurtis

EXPLORE FURTHER

This War of Mine

GAME

<https://www.thiswarofmine.com/>

Play and discuss This War of Mine or Papers, Please (addressing civic and ethical issues), or watch the Papers, Please short film on Steam or YouTube, or find gameplay on Twitch/YouTube

EXPLORE FURTHER

Papers, Please

GAME

<https://papersplea.se/>

Play and discuss This War of Mine or Papers, Please (addressing civic and ethical issues), or watch the Papers, Please short film on Steam or YouTube, or find gameplay on Twitch/YouTube

EXPLORE FURTHER

Papers, Please Short Film

YOUTUBE | ~11 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YFHHGETsxkE>

Play and discuss This War of Mine or Papers, Please (addressing civic and ethical issues), or watch the Papers, Please short film on Steam or YouTube, or find gameplay on Twitch/YouTube

EXPLORE FURTHER

Papers, Please Short Film

STEAM | ~11 MIN

https://store.steampowered.com/app/804320/Papers_Please_The_Short_Film/

Play and discuss This War of Mine or Papers, Please (addressing civic and ethical issues), or watch the Papers, Please short film on Steam or YouTube, or find gameplay on Twitch/YouTube